Store Management System — Product PRD

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Vision & Purpose

Atlas is a store operating system, not another app the owner has to check. It exists because running a physical store today means logging into five or more disconnected tools — POS, inventory, scheduling, bookkeeping, marketing — and manually reconciling numbers that should already agree.

Atlas replaces that stack with one system: one login, one dashboard, one source of truth for everything happening in the store, so the owner spends their time on customers and product, not software administration.

Target Users & Personas

Persona	Role	Primary need
Owner-operator	Runs one store, wears every hat	A single view of sales, stock, and cash without hiring a bookkeeper
Store manager	Runs day-to-day floor operations	Fast staff scheduling, reorder alerts, shift handoff clarity
Cashier / associate	Front-of-house, checkout	A checkout flow that never blocks a sale and needs no training
Multi-location operator	Owns or oversees 2–20 stores	Cross-location visibility, consistent reporting, centralized control

Every persona above works from the same data model — the owner's dashboard, the manager's schedule, and the cashier's checkout screen are three views of one system, not three products.

Problem Statement

- **Fragmented tools.** Inventory, POS, scheduling, and books live in separate systems that don't talk to each other, so the owner re-enters or reconciles the same data by hand.

- **Reactive inventory.** Stockouts and overstock are discovered after they've cost a sale or tied up cash, not predicted ahead of time.
- **Onboarding tax.** Most retail software takes hours or days to set up, often requiring a call with support or a paid implementation partner before the first sale runs through it.
- **Blind multi-location ownership.** Owners of more than one store rarely have one screen that shows all locations at once — they check each store's numbers separately, or not at all.

Core Features

Point of Sale

- Checkout in 2 taps or fewer for a repeat item
- Offline mode — sales queue and sync when connectivity returns
- Split tender, returns, exchanges, discounts, tax rules per location

Inventory

- Real-time stock counts across every location
- Automatic low-stock alerts and suggested reorder quantities
- Barcode/SKU scanning for receiving and counts
- Vendor and purchase-order tracking

Staffing

- Shift scheduling with conflict and overtime warnings
- Clock-in/out tied directly to scheduled shifts
- Labor-cost-to-sales ratio visible in real time, not end-of-month

Analytics

- One dashboard: sales, margin, shrink, sell-through, top/bottom performers
- Cross-location comparison for multi-store owners
- Demand forecasting to drive the reorder suggestions above

Hardware

- Terminal, cash drawer, and barcode scanner as one set-up unit
- Works out of the box — no separate hardware vendor, no certification step

Key User Workflows

First-time setup (owner)

1. Sign up, connect a bank account for payouts
2. Import or scan-in existing inventory
3. Add staff and set store hours
4. First sale runs within 15 minutes of account creation

Daily checkout (cashier)

1. Scan or tap item
2. Apply discount/tax automatically
3. Take payment (card, cash, split)
4. Receipt — print, text, or email

Restock decision (manager)

1. Low-stock alert fires from real-time inventory
2. Suggested reorder quantity shown, based on sell-through forecast
3. One-tap purchase order sent to vendor

Weekly review (multi-location owner)

1. Open cross-location dashboard
2. Compare sales, margin, and labor cost by store
3. Flag the underperforming location and drill into its detail view

Design Principles

- **No manual, no training video.** If a feature needs a support article to explain, it is not finished. Every screen should be usable by a first-time cashier with zero onboarding.
- **One number per decision.** A screen shows the one number that drives the next action (reorder now / don't), not a dashboard of everything that could theoretically be measured.
- **Defaults over settings.** Ship with the right default for the common case; hide configuration behind an "advanced" layer instead of surfacing it up front.
- **Delete before you add.** Every proposed feature is weighed against removing a step from an existing workflow, not just adding a new one.

- **The system should never contradict itself.** Inventory, sales, and labor numbers come from one ledger, so what the owner sees on the dashboard always matches what's on the floor — no separate exports that can drift out of sync.

Non-Functional Requirements

Requirement	Target
Checkout latency	Under 200ms per transaction, online
Offline resilience	Full checkout capability with no connectivity; sync on reconnect
Uptime	99.9% for POS/checkout path (this is the one path that must never go down)
Data security	PCI DSS compliance for all payment data; encryption at rest and in transit
Onboarding time	Under 15 minutes from signup to first sale
Platform	iOS/Android tablet app + owned hardware terminal; web dashboard for management and analytics

Success Metrics

- **Time to first sale** — minutes from signup to a completed transaction (target: under 15)
- **Support tickets per store per month** — a proxy for how self-explanatory the product actually is
- **Stockout rate** — % of SKUs out of stock at time of demand, trending down after adoption
- **Multi-module adoption** — % of stores using inventory + staffing + analytics, not just POS, within 90 days
- **Net revenue retention** — expansion from additional locations and modules outpacing churn

Release Phases

Phase	Scope
V1	POS + payments + inventory, single location, offline mode
V2	Staffing/scheduling, cross-location dashboard, demand forecasting
V3	Financing products (working capital, inventory advances), open API for third-party integrations

Each phase ships only once the prior phase's onboarding time and support-ticket targets are met — scope expands after simplicity is proven, not before.